Section B: Mark Scheme & Model Answer

Exam code: 0475 & 0992

Download PDF

Written by: Deb Orrock
Reviewed by: Kate Lee
Updated on 15 October 2024

Section B: Mark Scheme and Model Answer

The best way to improve any essay is to know how you are assessed, and what skills you are being assessed on. This page has been created to give you a sense of what examiners are looking for in a full-mark response. It contains:

- Overview
- Mark scheme
- Example task
- Model answer
- Unannotated model answer

Overview

Section B (Prose) will require you to answer one question from a choice of two. One of the questions will be based on a printed extract from a text, and the other will be an essay-style question. You will be asked to explore, or analyse, how a writer has achieved particular meanings or ideas. Your response must also be supported with direct quotations or close reference to the text.

Mark scheme

The mark scheme for any question in Literature in English is quite broad and can seem difficult to understand. This is because there is no "correct answer" for any essay: the exam board does not provide points that need to be included in any essay; instead, examiners use the mark scheme to place an answer into a level.

The questions in Paper 1 are equally weighted, and each question tests all four Assessment Objectives.

In simple terms, to achieve the highest marks (Band 8 = 23–25 marks), this means:

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

	• This means using quotations and indirect references to the text to support your views or arguments
AO2	• Sustain a critical understanding of the text by showing individuality and insight • This means showing that you understand the main ideas, settings, events and characters, and that you appreciate the deeper meanings of the text
AO3	• Respond sensitively and in considerable detail to the way the writer achieves her/his effects • This means that you are able to explore how writers use language, structure and form to convey impressions and ideas
AO4	• Sustain a personal and evaluative engagement with the task and text • This means that you are able to give a personal response to the question and text, and support your response with references to the text

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Although there are four specific Assessment Objectives assessed in this task, it is not the case that a certain number of marks are awarded for any one objective. Instead, the examiners are looking for a well-constructed and coherent essay that seamlessly combines all of the skills covered by the Assessment Objectives.

Example task

The following task is taken from the 2021 Paper 1 exam paper:

Either 17 Read this passage, and then answer the question that follows it.

Presently they fell asleep for a little while. When Winston woke up the hands of the clock had crept round to nearly nine. He did not stir, because Julia was sleeping with her head in the crook of his arm. Most of her make-up had transferred itself to his own face or the bolster, but a light stain of rouge still brought out the beauty of her cheekbone. A yellow ray from the sinking sun fell across the foot of the bed and lighted up the fireplace, where the water in the pan was boiling fast. Down in the yard the woman had stopped singing, but the faint shouts of children floated in from the street. He wondered vaguely whether in the abolished past it had been a normal experience to lie in bed like this, in the cool of a summer evening, a man and a woman with no clothes on, making love when they chose, talking of what they chose, not feeling any compulsion to get up, simply lying there and listening to peaceful sounds outside. Surely there could never have been a time when that seemed ordinary? Julia woke up, rubbed her eyes and raised herself on her elbow to look at the oilstove.

'Half that water's boiled away,' she said. 'I'll get up and make some coffee in another moment. We've got an hour. What time do they cut the lights off at your flats?'

'Twenty-three thirty.'

'It's twenty-three at the hostel. But you have to get in earlier than that, because – Hi! Get out, you filthy brute!'

She suddenly twisted herself over in the bed, seized a shoe from the floor and sent it hurtling into the corner with a boyish jerk of her arm, exactly as he had seen her fling the dictionary at Goldstein, that morning during the Two Minutes Hate.

'What was it?' he said in surprise.

'A rat. I saw him stick his beastly nose out of the wainscoting. There's a hole down there. I gave him a good fright, anyway.'

'Rats!' murmured Winston. 'In this room!'

'They're all over the place,' said Julia indifferently as she lay down again. 'We've even got them in the kitchen at the hostel. Some parts of London are swarming with them. Did you know they attack children? Yes, they do. In some of these streets a woman daren't leave a baby alone for two minutes. It's the great huge brown ones that do it. And the nasty thing is that the brutes always – '

'*Don't go on!*' said Winston, with his eyes tightly shut.

'Dearest! You've gone quite pale. What's the matter? Do they make you feel sick?'

'Of all horrors in the world – a rat!'

She pressed herself against him and wound her limbs round him, as though to reassure him with the warmth of her body. He did not re-open his eyes immediately. For several moments he had had the feeling of being back in a nightmare which had recurred from time to time throughout his life. It was always very much the same. He was standing in front of a wall of darkness, and on the other side of it there was something unendurable, something too dreadful to be faced. In the dream his deepest feeling was always one of self-deception, because he did in fact know what was behind the wall of darkness. With a deadly effort, like wrenching a piece out of his own brain, he could even have dragged the thing into the open. He always woke up without discovering what it was: but somehow it was connected with what Julia had been saying when he cut her short.

'I'm sorry,' he said; 'it's nothing. I don't like rats, that's all.'

'Don't worry, dear, we're not going to have the filthy brutes in here. I'll stuff the hole with a bit of sacking before we go. And next time we come here I'll bring some plaster and bung it up properly.'

(*from* Part 2)

How does Orwell make this moment in the novel so memorable and significant?

Model Answer

Below you will find a full-mark model answer for this task. The commentary labelled in each section of the essay illustrates how and why it would be awarded full marks. Despite the fact it is an answer to the above question on George Orwell's 1984, the commentary is relevant to any prose response, because it is modelling how to structure an answer incorporating the relevant Assessment Objectives.

The introduction addresses the focus of the question and demonstrates knowledge of the novel as a whole

Orwell makes this moment in the novel so memorable and significant because it draws upon several key themes, such as the relationship between Winston and Julia, the significance of dreams, and the passage of time. It also foreshadows Winston's eventual torture at the hands of O'Brien in Room 101 in The Ministry of Love.

Copyright © Save My Exams. All Rights Reserved

Unannotated model answer

Orwell makes this moment in the novel so memorable and significant because it draws upon several key themes, such as the relationship between Winston and Julia, the significance of dreams, and the passage of time. It also foreshadows Winston's eventual torture at the hands of O'Brien in Room 101 in The Ministry of Love.

The passage is memorable because Winston and Julia experience a temporary moment of happiness and peace. Winston does not "stir" because he does not want to disturb the moment. The writer describes a "yellow ray" from the "sinking sun" creating a dream-like quality to the moment, which is juxtaposed with the water in the pan "boiling fast", reflecting the swift passage of time. This reminds the reader that Winston and Julia's peace cannot last, as Winston knows that his betrayals of Big Brother will be discovered in the end.

Furthermore, the differences in Winston and Julia's characters are highlighted in that Winston is reflecting on the moment and wondering about how things might have been in a time before Oceania, with people doing normal things and going about their normal lives, "simply lying there and listening to peaceful sounds outside". Julia, however, stays asleep, unconcerned that some of the make-up she had applied in a ***parody*** *of normality had rubbed off. This is memorable because it reminds the reader that Winston is the epitome of "thoughtcrime", whereas Julia appears just to live in the moment and not concern herself with the consequences.*

The passage is also memorable because it starts by describing the scene almost like a dream, with the sounds from outside floating in "the cool of a summer evening". This contrasts with Winston's description of his recurring nightmare, in which he is standing "in front of a wall of darkness" knowing that on the other side there was "something unendurable". What is behind the wall is both symbolic and real, as behind the metaphoric wall is Winston's fate, and behind the real wall in the room is the hidden telescreen.

Winston goes on to reveal that he knows what is behind the wall, but that he practises "self-deception", pretending that he doesn't. This mirrors the self-deception he is currently practising in pretending that his affair and rebellion against Big Brother will not be discovered and punished, even though he knows, deep down, that it will. Later on in Part 2, just before he and Julia are arrested, Winston declares that "We are the dead", revealing that he knows that his time is

running out.

else, as he states "Of all the horrors in the world – a rat!" This foreshadows Winston's breaking point later in the novel, as O'Brien uses a cage of rats to break Winston's spirit in Room 101, a place where prisoners are sent to confront their deepest fear. The presence of the rat is a further indication that their safe refuge might not be so safe after all. Julia, always practical, offers to "fix" the problem by "stuffing the hole with a bit of sacking before we go", but Winston knows there is ultimately no fixing the situation.

In addition, Julia's reaction to the rat, flinging a shoe at it, is compared to her flinging the dictionary at "Goldstein, that morning during the Two Minutes Hate". She goes on to start to describe how prole women "daren't leave a baby alone for two minutes", implying the significance of that amount of time in which horrible things can happen. Orwell links the rat to something that can inflict pain and terror, just like Big Brother. The fact that Winston's deepest fear is rats is also significant, as rats are associated with people who betray other people, which is exactly what happens to Winston and Julia, as they are betrayed by Mr Charrington, the owner of the shop.

Overall, this passage offers a significant revelation to the reader, and a taste of Winston's eventual fate, as well as being memorable for it being reflective of the themes of time and dreams versus reality.

Teacher only

Test your students on this in just a few clicks

- Create exam-aligned tests
- Tailor format & difficulty
- Quizzes or homework in minutes

Try Test Builder →

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Resources

Learning Hub

Scholarship

Join

Past Papers

Solution Banks

Sitemap

Dashboard

Overview

Brand ambassador

Profile

Subscription

Settings

Log out

Company

About us

Exam Specificity

Content Quality

Promotions

Jobs

Terms

Privacy

Cookie Policy

Help and Support

Subjects

Biology

Chemistry

Physics

Maths

Geography

English Literature

Psychology

All Subjects

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.